MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD and Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including recent hands-on work building and maintaining CI/CD pipelines, test environments, and build tooling. Experienced with GitLab CI, Docker, Helm, Kubernetes-based test environments, Linux, and Python and Bash automation. Moving toward DevOps and platform engineering, with additional personal experience running a k3s homelab and provisioning a Hetzner VPS with Terraform.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and Infrastructure: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal projects)
Containers and Platforms: Kubernetes (Helm deployments and namespace-level access), k3s, Argo CD
Monitoring and Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL
Programming and Scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Systems: Linux, Git, Ansible (basic)
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | Wroclaw
2021-Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for 3 product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration, and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes through parallel test jobs, dependency caching, and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; reduced monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster; environments include the application, PostgreSQL, and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data and built Grafana dashboards using CI test results to help teams identify flaky tests.
- Wrote the internal guide to how CI works, used in onboarding; mentored 2 QA interns in 2023.
- Work with namespace-level access on the shared Kubernetes cluster; the platform team operates the cluster.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw 2019-2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw 2018-2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal 2024-2025

- Ran a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices; deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana, and Loki for monitoring, with Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation | Exam scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)